

Helix Infrastructure Modernisation Programme

Master Project Charter v2.1

1. Executive Summary

The Helix Programme replaces the organisation's legacy data infrastructure with a cloud-native architecture across three sequential phases: Foundation, Integration, and Production Deployment. The programme is governed by the Helix Steering Committee and is subject to mandatory regulatory approval from the Compliance Authority before any phase may proceed to production.

2. Phase 1 ? Foundation (1 March 2026 to 30 April 2026)

The Foundation Phase establishes the core data layer. Database Migration requires Legacy System Shutdown to be completed first, because the migration tooling cannot run against a live production database. Security Audit requires Database Migration to be complete, as the audit scope covers only the new schema and encrypted storage layer. The Compliance Authority requires Legacy System Shutdown to remain active throughout the audit window to preserve the official audit trail · therefore the Compliance Authority blocks Legacy System Shutdown during the audit period. Data Encryption Module produces the encryption key manifest consumed by Security Audit. The Foundation Phase is scheduled to begin on 1 March 2026 and end on 30 April 2026.

3. Structural Conflict ? Audit Trail Paradox

Security Audit requires Database Migration. Database Migration requires Legacy System Shutdown. Compliance Authority blocks Legacy System Shutdown. This creates a direct operational paradox: the audit cannot proceed without the migration, the migration cannot proceed without the shutdown, yet the Compliance Authority forbids the shutdown while the audit is in scope. The Helix Steering Committee has not resolved this conflict as of the date of this charter.

4. Phase 2 ? Integration (1 May 2026 to 31 July 2026)

The Integration Phase connects the migrated data layer to the application tier. API Gateway requires Phase 1 Foundation to be complete before deployment begins. Load Balancer requires API Gateway to be active before traffic routing is enabled. Network Upgrade modifies the API Gateway port configuration and must be applied before API Gateway is installed. However, Network Upgrade blocks API Gateway installation during its maintenance window because the port reassignment causes a service conflict on the target hosts. Integration Testing produces the

system validation report required by Production Deployment. The Integration Phase is scheduled to start after the Foundation Phase ends. Phase 2 starts on 1 May 2026. Phase 1 ends on 30 April 2026.

Production Deployment requires Integration Testing to be complete and the system validation report to be signed off by the Quality Assurance Board. Regulatory Hold blocks Production Deployment whenever an open compliance finding is recorded by the Compliance Authority. The Quality Assurance Board requires Security Audit sign-off before approving the system validation report. Production Deployment is scheduled to start on 15 June 2026. Integration Testing ends on 31 July 2026. Production Deployment must start after Integration Testing ends.

6. Schedule Conflict ? Negative Slack

Production Deployment is scheduled to begin on 15 June 2026. Integration Testing is not scheduled to complete until 31 July 2026. Production Deployment must start after Integration Testing ends, creating a negative slack of 46 days: the deployment is planned to start 46 days before its predecessor activity is complete. Similarly, Phase 2 Integration is planned to start on 1 May 2026. Phase 1 Foundation ends on 30 April 2026. This is a zero-slack dependency; any overrun in Phase 1 immediately delays Phase 2.

7. Resource Conflicts

The Database Administration Team is assigned to both Database Migration in Phase 1 and to Integration Testing in Phase 2. Database Migration requires the Database Administration Team full-time from 1 March 2026 to 30 April 2026. Integration Testing requires the Database Administration Team from 1 May 2026. The Network Engineering Team is assigned to Network Upgrade and to Load Balancer configuration. Network Upgrade blocks Load Balancer configuration because the routing tables cannot be finalised until the port reassignment is complete. The Security Team produces the encryption key manifest and also conducts Security Audit. Security Audit requires the encryption key manifest produced by the Security Team's Data Encryption Module, meaning the Security Team blocks itself if the encryption module is deprioritised.

8. Regulatory Dependencies

The Compliance Authority requires formal sign-off at four mandatory checkpoints: before Legacy System Shutdown, before Database Migration, before API Gateway deployment, and before Production Deployment. Each checkpoint requires a completed audit package from the Security Team. Regulatory Hold is automatically triggered if any checkpoint is bypassed. Regulatory Hold blocks Production

Deployment, blocks API Gateway deployment, and blocks Legacy System Shutdown concurrently. The Helix Steering Committee produces the programme authority required by the Compliance Authority to open each checkpoint. The Compliance Authority blocks all deployment activities until checkpoint approval is received, creating a hard sequential dependency across all three phases.

9. Risk Register

Risk R-01: Legacy System Shutdown is blocked by Compliance Authority.

Probability: High. Impact: blocks Database Migration and therefore the entire Foundation Phase. Risk R-02: Network Upgrade maintenance window overlaps with API Gateway installation. The Network Upgrade blocks API Gateway. If the maintenance window extends beyond its scheduled end date of 15 May 2026, API Gateway installation cannot begin until Network Upgrade completes, delaying the Integration Phase end date of 31 July 2026. Risk R-03: Security Team capacity is required simultaneously for Data Encryption Module and Security Audit. Data Encryption Module must produce its output before Security Audit begins. If the Security Team is not available from 1 March 2026, the entire audit schedule slips, pushing the Production Deployment start date beyond 15 June 2026. Risk R-04: Quality Assurance Board sign-off requires Security Audit completion. If Security Audit is delayed past 30 June 2026, the Quality Assurance Board cannot approve the system validation report in time for the Production Deployment gate.

10. Approval and Authority

This charter is approved by the Helix Steering Committee effective 1 February 2026. The programme authority expires on 31 December 2026. All phase gate decisions require a quorum of the Helix Steering Committee plus written approval from the Compliance Authority. The Compliance Authority produces the gate approval notice consumed by each phase. The Helix Steering Committee requires the Compliance Authority gate approval notice before authorising budget release for each phase. Budget Release requires Helix Steering Committee approval. Phase 1 budget release is scheduled for 15 February 2026. Phase 2 budget release must start after Phase 1 budget release and is scheduled for 15 April 2026. Phase 1 budget release ends on 28 February 2026, so Phase 2 budget release starts after Phase 1 budget release ends · no negative slack here.